11/25 WED — THE PARKING LOT SCAMS

Airdate Wed Nov 25, 2026 · tapes Fri Nov 20 · A only (one long story, four scams) · no guest · 1 break · Stage: videos

SUMMARY

The most dangerous minute of a shopping trip is in the parking lot: arms full, trunk open, purse in the cart. Police say organized crews work store lots from Costco to Walmart to Sam's Club with four moves: a "gift" necklace that swaps out your real gold, a purse grabbed while you load and cards drained before you get home, a car that suddenly won't start, and a tracker stuck under your car. Four scams, each with its tell, then five moves that protect you every time you load the car.

THE SHOW

1. Tease (opens on clip 1: the 86-year-old's daughter: "They're putting this gift around dad's neck as they're somehow removing his chain")
2. TWO STRANGERS PUT A "GIFT" ON THIS 86-YEAR-OLD… AND TOOK HIS GOLD (clip 1)
3. THE SAME TRICK TOOK A TUSKEGEE AIRMAN'S RING… AND POLICE GOT IT BACK (clip 2)
4. FIGHT BACK, AND THESE CREWS GET VIOLENT (clip 3)
5. THEY'LL GRAB YOUR PURSE WHILE YOU LOAD THE CAR (clip 4)
6. THEY CAN DRAIN YOUR CARDS BEFORE YOU EVEN GET HOME (clip 5)
7. //// Break: generic ad lead-in
8. YOUR CAR WON'T START… AND THE "HELPERS" ARE ALREADY WAITING (clip 6)
9. SOMEONE COULD PUT A TRACKER ON YOUR CAR WHILE YOU SHOP (clip 7, demo)
10. HERE'S HOW TO PROTECT YOURSELF
11. Close

THE TEASE

A1 · the hook

- Two friendly strangers help an older man load his groceries… then hang a "gift" necklace around his neck.
- By the time they drive off, his real gold is gone. And it happened in a parking lot just like the one you'll be in this week.
- You're going to meet his family, and see how the same trick took a Tuskegee Airman's ring, and how police got it back.
- Then the crews who grab your purse while you load the car, the car that suddenly won't start, and the tracker you'd never see.
- Plus the one thing to do before you put a single bag in the trunk.

TWO STRANGERS PUT A "GIFT" ON THIS 86-YEAR-OLD… AND TOOK HIS GOLD

A2 · San Jose, CA (Costco) · Aug 2026

- I love shopping at Costco. So when I hear crews are working its parking lots, I want to stop them.
- This couple had just finished their grocery run and popped the trunk.
- Two women walked right up and started loading the groceries for them. He said thanks, he could do it himself.
- So what happened next?

CLIP 1 (HORIZONTAL): NBC Bay Area — Elderly San Jose couple robbed of treasured heirloom in coordinated parking lot theft · Aug 2026 · 2:30

    - **0:29–0:55 ("WE HAVE TO HELP THE ELDERLY") // BUTT 1:16–1:54 ("TEMPORARILY BLOCKED THEM FROM LEAVING")**
    - *Soundbite: "It was the end of their grocery run... when they popped the trunk of their car, two women immediately began loading their groceries... 'I can do it by myself. I don't need help, thanks.' But he said that they told him, 'God says we have to help the elderly.'" // "...one woman then followed the husband as he got in the car and gave him a necklace. 'They're putting in this gift around dad's neck as they're somehow removing his chain.'... stealing his 18-karat gold medallion, an heirloom given to him by the priest who married them more than 50 years ago... another car with at least two men in it pulled up behind their car and temporarily blocked them from leaving."*
- **Out:** An heirloom from the priest who married them, gone in seconds, and a second car blocking them in. That's not a random thief. That's a crew.
- **Red flag:** a stranger who insists on helping you load the car. Say no, and close the trunk.

THE SAME TRICK TOOK A TUSKEGEE AIRMAN'S RING... AND POLICE GOT IT BACK

A3 · Renton, WA (Walmart) · Feb 2026 · ⚠️ old case

- And it's not just one parking lot. Police are seeing the same move outside Walmarts and grocery stores.
- Near Seattle, a woman walked up to this 71-year-old man, offered him five dollars, then said she just wanted to bless him.
- His necklace held a ring that belonged to his brother, a Tuskegee Airman. So what did she do?

CLIP 2 (HORIZONTAL): FOX 13 Seattle — Police arrest alleged crime group accused of 'blessing' jewelry thefts · Feb 2026 · about 6:00

    - **1:32–2:14 ("PILOTS IN U.S. HISTORY") // BUTT 3:23–3:45 ("THAT BELONGED TO MY BROTHER")**
    - *Soundbite: "We talked and next thing I know, a $5 bill popped up and she told me, take this... Oh no, I just want to bless you... Undeterred, police say she moved to put this cheap necklace around his neck... while she was clamping it around my neck. That's how she stole this off of my neck... His necklace held three rings, including one that belonged to his brother, Otis Forman, a member of the Tuskegee Airmen..." // "Detectives got a search warrant for the vehicle and found Ricki's stolen necklace for him... that was the only thing I really cared about. Was getting the ring back. That belonged to my brother."*
    - ⚠️ LEGAL: the woman and her group are accused, not convicted; they pleaded not guilty (4:00, outside the cut). The package names the group's nationality in its first minute; the cut and the copy don't.
- **Out:** They got his brother's ring back. I love it when police step in like that. But not everyone walks away.
- **Red flag:** "I just want to bless you," and a hand reaching for your neck. Step back and walk away.

FIGHT BACK, AND THESE CREWS GET VIOLENT

A4 · Lynnwood, WA (H Mart) · Dec 2025 · ⚠️ old case

- But it gets worse: these crews don't always stop at a trick.
- Police say the same group was connected to another parking lot, where a man was sitting in his car with his wife.
- They went for his watch. So what happened when his wife tried to stop them?

CLIP 3 (HORIZONTAL): FOX 13 Seattle — Police arrest alleged crime group accused of 'blessing' jewelry thefts · Feb 2026 · about 6:00

    - **5:36–5:48 ("AND BROKE A VERTEBRAE") // BUTT 5:52–6:00 ("CASH MONEY THEY SEIZED AS EVIDENCE")**
    - *Soundbite: "Surveillance video from December showed the couple try to steal a man's watch as he sat in his car in the parking lot of the H Mart, when the victim's wife tried to get the watch back, she was knocked to the ground, hit her head, and broke a vertebrae." // "Detectives say when they searched her, they found two socks in her purse. Each sock contained $40,000 cash money they seized as evidence."*

    - ⚠️ LEGAL: the two accused are named at 5:48–5:52, between the segments; the cut skips them. Charges, not convictions.
- **Out:** A broken vertebra, over a watch. And eighty thousand dollars in cash, stuffed in two socks. This is a business.
- **Red flag:** if someone grabs for your jewelry, let it go. Nothing you're wearing is worth your back.

THEY'LL GRAB YOUR PURSE WHILE YOU LOAD THE CAR

A5 · Vallejo, CA (Costco) · Aug 2025 · ⚠️ old case

- And now it's not a trick at all. It's your purse, and it takes seconds.
- This woman was loading her groceries into her car in a store parking lot.
- A car parked nearby was recording the whole thing. Watch what happens.

CLIP 4 (HORIZONTAL): NBC Bay Area — Woman robbed in Costco parking lot in Vallejo · Aug 21, 2025 · 0:27

    - **0:00–0:27 ("ABOUT AN HOUR LATER"), WHOLE CLIP**
    - *Soundbite: "New video from a Tesla shows a woman robbed as she loaded her groceries... this is the Costco parking lot in Vallejo. A masked man approaches her, throws her to the ground... takes off with her purse. The woman then gets up and actually chases after him. Police say two minors were arrested... the pair robbed another woman the same way in another parking lot two miles away about an hour later."*
    - ⚠️ LEGAL: the suspects are minors (unnamed, not shown); keep it that way.
    - ⚠️ UNVERIFIED: timed from a Whisper transcript of the site video. No YouTube copy found, so the site link stays.
- **Out:** Knocked to the ground, for a purse. And another woman, an hour later, two miles away.
- **Red flag:** your purse in the cart or on the seat while your back is turned. That's the moment they wait for.

THEY CAN DRAIN YOUR CARDS BEFORE YOU EVEN GET HOME

A6 · Portland, OR (Costco) · May 2024 · ⚠️ old case

- But it gets worse: once they have your wallet, they move fast.
- Police in Portland released this video from a store parking lot. Watch the three men behind this 93-year-old.
- He was home in about half an hour. So how much had they spent by then?

CLIP 5 (HORIZONTAL): KATU News — 93-year-old Portland man pickpocketed; thieves used credit cards to buy $100s in gift cards · May 2024 · 1:16

    - **0:19–0:38 ("$1,500 ON VISA GIFT CARDS") // BUTT 0:59–1:05 ("OLDER MORE VULNERABLE PEOPLE")**
    - *Soundbite: "...you can see three men follow the victim out of the store walking closely behind him. One of them takes the wallet from the man's back pocket. Now police say the suspects used his credit cards within 30 minutes of the theft. This is video from a Fred Meyer where they spent $1,500 on Visa gift cards." // "Now police say the suspects seem to be targeting older, more vulnerable people."*
- **Out:** Fifteen hundred dollars in gift cards, within half an hour. Before he even knew his wallet was gone.
- **Red flag:** gift cards are the first thing they buy. Wallet gone? Call your card companies before you leave the lot.

//////////////////////

BREAK — generic ad lead-in. *Next:* the car that won't start right when two helpful men show up, and the tracker someone can stick under your car while you shop.

//////////////////////

YOUR CAR WON'T START... AND THE "HELPERS" ARE ALREADY WAITING

A7 · Lehi, UT (Costco) · Jun 2026

- And now they're getting to your car while you're still inside the store.

- This woman came out of a store in Utah, got in her car, and it wouldn't start.
- Two men parked nearby were happy to help.
- One opened the fuse box and said he could fix it, for two hundred dollars. So what did police find on the parking lot cameras?

CLIP 6 (HORIZONTAL): ABC4 Utah — SCAM Alert! In Utah County, people are being targeted in parking lots · date unconfirmed · 1:04

  - ⚠️ THROTTLED: YouTube blocked the captions on three tries, so there's no in–out yet. Re-run the caption fetch before the bible.
  - ⚠️ MANUAL alternate: the woman's own TikTok, @jasnahooke (447K+ views per Motor1; the post's URL isn't published). TikTok blocks requests from here.
- **Out:** They broke her car, then offered to fix it. And in Virginia, the sheriff warns about a version where a "Good Samaritan" points out your flat tire while a partner opens your door.
- **Red flag:** your car worked when you went in, and the help is already standing there. Stay in, lock the doors, call for help yourself.

SOMEONE COULD PUT A TRACKER ON YOUR CAR WHILE YOU SHOP

A8 · Auburn, AL (Sam's Club / Walmart) · Sep 2025 · ⚠️ old case

- And now it's not just your purse or your car. This one follows you home.
- This woman was driving home from shopping when her iPhone popped up a warning she'd never seen before.
- It said a tracking device was moving with her, ever since the Sam's Club parking lot.
- So what did her brother find under her car?

CLIP 7 (HORIZONTAL): WTVM — Tracker found underneath woman's car in Auburn · Sep 15, 2025 · 3:13

  - **0:47–1:20 ("ALL OVER FROM WHERE I WENT") // BUTT 1:20–1:41 ("REPORT IT TO LAW ENFORCEMENT")**
  - *Soundbite: "I was riding home yesterday and I got a notification on my iPhone and it said tracking notification... shocked to find this small GPS tracker with audio capabilities underneath her car... it said that it started pinging my phone at 4:50 at Sam's Club and it was still continuously tracking me and it tracked me back home to my mom's house and then all over from where I went." // "Bedford said she believes the tracker was placed on her car while she was at Walmart in Opelika... investigators... say if anyone finds a suspicious tracker on their vehicle to immediately report it to law enforcement."*
  - ⚠️ UNVERIFIED: timed from a Whisper transcript of the site video (site metadata said 32:05; real length 3:13). No YouTube copy found.

DEMO (show-produced): Jim Stickley hides a tracker on a car; Jeff's iPhone and an Android phone both alert, and Jeff shows where to check: the license plate, the fuel door, the wheel wells.

- **Out:** Her phone caught it. Yours can too, if one setting is on. I'll show you in a minute.
- **Red flag:** "found moving with you" on your phone. Don't drive home. Drive somewhere busy and call police.

HERE'S HOW TO PROTECT YOURSELF

A9 · the fix

1. **PURSE IN THE CAR FIRST... THEN LOCK THE DOORS WHILE YOU LOAD** (the one thing from the tease)
   - Before a single bag goes in the trunk, your purse or wallet goes inside the car, and the doors get locked.
   - Never leave a purse in the cart or on the seat while your back is turned.
2. **NO STRANGER PUTS ANYTHING ON YOU, OR LOADS YOUR CAR**
   - Not a necklace, not a scarf, not a hug, not a "blessing." Step back and say no.
   - Leave the good jewelry at home, or tuck it in when you shop. And if someone grabs for it, let it go.
3. **WALLET GONE? CALL YOUR CARD COMPANIES BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE LOT**

- They're buying gift cards within minutes. Every minute counts.
- Turn on purchase alerts on every card so you see a charge the second it happens.

4. **CAR WON'T START? STAY INSIDE AND LOCK THE DOORS**
    - Call roadside assistance or police yourself. Never let a stranger work on your car.
5. **TURN ON TRACKER ALERTS ON YOUR PHONE** *(demo)*
    - iPhone: Settings, Notifications, Tracking Notifications, on. Bluetooth and Location Services have to be on too.
    - Android: Settings, Safety and emergency, Unknown tracker alerts. Tap Scan now for a check anytime.
    - Find one? Don't drive home. Go somewhere busy and call police.

CLOSE

- Send this to someone who does the big grocery run, before their next trip.
- The next video to watch. See you next time.

BUILD SHEET

For Claude and the pipeline. The room can skip this page.

Spine

- **In one sentence:** Crews work store parking lots in the minute your arms are full and your trunk is open: a fake gift that takes your gold, a purse grab that drains your cards, a sabotaged car, a hidden tracker; put your purse in the car and lock the doors before you load, and never let a stranger help, touch or "fix."
- **Hold back:** the purse-first, lock-the-doors move (step 1) and the tracker setting (step 5). The tease promises "the one thing to do before you put a single bag in the trunk"; it doesn't say what.
- **Peg:** the busiest shopping weekend of the year (airs the day before Thanksgiving; Black Friday Nov 27), with the Sacramento County Sheriff's warning on jewelry distraction thefts at Costco, Sam's Club, Walmart, Lowe's and Home Depot (Jul 27, 2026) and Boone County, WV's Nov 1, 2026 lot tips. The copy stays evergreen (Jeff, 11/11): no holiday, Black Friday or season in any spoken line.
- **Climb:** four scams, each closer and harder to stop: a trick you can refuse (A2–A3), then it turns violent (A4) → no trick, just force (A5), and the damage spreads before you're home (A6) → they get to your car while you're inside (A7) → they follow you home (A8) → you take it back.
- **Framing:** a stranger in a store parking lot while you shop or load your car. Stores: Costco (A2, A5, A6, A7), Walmart (A3), H Mart (A4), Sam's Club and Walmart (A8). Costco opens the show (Jeff's line) but isn't the only store; the title says "parking lot." Never "panhandlers": every case takes money, jewelry, a purse or your safety.
- **Open package:** clip 1, the daughter: "They're putting this gift around dad's neck as they're somehow removing his chain."
- **Payoff point:** A9 (step 1, purse in the car first).
- **Weight:** 100% of show · 7 clips · four scams (necklace swap ~40%, purse and cards ~25%, car ~15%, tracker ~20%).

Beats

Beat	Clip	Who	Tag	Status	Adds	Search specifics
A1	—	You (the viewer)	JEFF	—	—	—
A2	1	Couple, 86 and 75, and their daughter, San Jose CA (Aug 2026)	FIND · HORIZONTAL	PICK	evidence: the real result, a crew	NBC Bay Area, Mayra Franco; YouTube qR0sQsMqBJc (captions); Costco at Almaden Plaza; 18K medallion from the priest who married them; second car blocked them in; SJPD news release Aug 25, 2026 (three arrested for chain-snatch robberies)
A3	2	Rickey Foreman, 71,	HAVE · HORIZONTAL	PICK · LEGAL	development: organized, and	FOX 13 Seattle YouTube

		Renton WA (Feb 2026)			caught	X_pAsqSPpgY (captions); Bellevue PD Special Enforcement Team; Renton Walmart Supercenter; brother Otis Foreman, Tuskegee Airman; necklace recovered; theft 1st degree; not-guilty pleas
A4	3	A man and his wife, Lynnwood WA (Dec 2025)	FIND · HORIZONTAL	PICK · LEGAL	stakes: it turns violent; development: $80,000 in cash	FOX 13 Seattle YouTube X_pAsqSPpgY 5:36–6:00 (captions); H Mart parking lot; wife knocked down, broken vertebra; two arrested in Bellevue; two socks, $40,000 each; alt KCRA rnZwK4JOuL8 "Sacramento County jewelry theft scams turn violent" (captions blocked)
A5	4	Woman loading groceries, Vallejo CA (Aug 2025)	HAVE · HORIZONTAL	PICK · LEGAL · UNVERIFIED	evidence: caught on camera, force	NBC Bay Area video page (NBCStations, 0:27), Tesla camera; two minors arrested; second robbery two miles away an hour later
A6	5	Man, 93, Portland OR (May 2024)	HAVE · HORIZONTAL	PICK	stakes: cards drained in 30 minutes	KATU YouTube XgkNrTUgYgU (captions); Portland PD; Costco NE Portland; Fred Meyer, $1,500 Visa gift cards; WinCo PIN watching; Det.

						Jordan Zaitz (KOIN)
A7	6	Jasna (@jasnahooke), Lehi/American Fork UT (Jun 2026)	FIND · HORIZONTAL	THROTTLED	development: they get to your car while you shop	ABC4 Utah YouTube kUy077XD5To (captions blocked three times); Motor1 Jun 28, 2026; 2017 Corolla; fuse pulled; $200; American Fork PD warning Jun 2025; TikTok @jasnahooke 447K+ per Motor1; Culpeper County, VA Sheriff flat-tire warning (Fredericksburg Free Press, Aug 10, 2025); second Utah Costco case Sep 2026 (The Mary Sue)
A8	7	Kansas Bedford, Auburn/Opelika AL (Sep 2025)	FIND · HORIZONTAL	PICK · UNVERIFIED	stakes: they follow you home	WTVM site video (ArcPublishing, real length 3:13), Justin Brown; iPhone tracking notification; first ping 4:50 at Sam's Club; believes placed at Opelika Walmart; magnetic GPS tracker with audio; Fort Wayne alt WPTA lOy9S2jWGOE (captions blocked)
A9	—	You (the viewer)	DEMO	—	—	—

Jeff should know

- A2: NBC's video ran before any arrests ("we have not yet received a response" from police). San Jose police announced three arrests in chain-snatch robberies on Aug 25, 2026; the reporting doesn't tie them to this couple. Don't say they were caught.
- A2: the couple spoke Spanish; the daughter's bite is the English one. They reported it to San Jose police.
- A3: February 2026. Three arrested, a fourth charged; all pleaded not guilty. Police and FOX 13 name a nationality; we say "an organized group."
- A4: December 2025 (Lynnwood H-Mart). Police connected this couple to the Bellevue group; both were arrested. Charges, not convictions. The $40,000 in each sock is what detectives say they found.
- A5: August 2025. The suspects are minors; never name or describe them beyond "two teenagers."
- A6: May 2024. Police say the same group watched shoppers enter PINs inside a WinCo, then stole wallets in the lot.
- A7: the police-footage detail is her account (via Motor1); confirm with Lehi or American Fork police, or say "she says." The Virginia flat-tire line is the Culpeper County Sheriff's warning (Aug 2025).
- A8: September 2025. Motive unknown: say "someone," never "thieves." She believes it was placed at the Walmart; it first pinged at Sam's Club.
- Costco is the hero's store, not the villain: nobody says its lots are less safe than anyone else's. Ask Costco for comment ("we reached out").
- Cut from the 11/11 version (producer, 11/11: fewer scams, more depth, not all Costco): the fake-gold-for-gas-money beat (Mettawa, IL, $15,800; it was also closest to the dead list's "panhandling hustles").
- Collision: Jeff's approved donation tap-to-pay standalone says that scam is "spreading to the busiest parking lots." It's out of this show; if it airs first, one callback line.

The fix: sources

- Step 1: purse in the car, lock the doors while loading (King County Sheriff via KIRO 7, Jun 24, 2019; Portland PD via KOIN, May 24, 2024); trunk purchases, lock every time (Boone County, WV Sheriff via WTAP, Nov 2, 2026).
- Step 2: "never allow strangers to place jewelry, scarves or other items around their necks"; leave valuable jewelry home or covered (Sacramento County Sheriff via Folsom Times, Jul 27, 2026). ⚠️ "Refuse unrequested help loading" and "let it go" rest on the San Jose and Lynnwood cases; no police source yet.
- Step 3: card thieves bought gift cards within 30 minutes (Portland PD via KATU); purchase alerts ⚠️ issuer-specific.
- Step 4: stay in your locked car and call police (Culpeper County Sheriff via Fredericksburg Free Press, Aug 10, 2025); never let strangers work on your car (American Fork PD via ABC4, Jun 1, 2025).
- Step 5: iPhone Tracking Notifications, Bluetooth and Location Services (Apple Support); Android Unknown tracker alerts and Scan now (Google Support); report it to police (WTVM, Opelika investigators). ⚠️ "Don't drive home, go somewhere busy" needs a named police source (SPD's Sarah Lawson, KIRO 7, Nov 2023, is the closest).
- Do-nothing test: the viewer who only locks the doors (step 1) is still exposed to the necklace swap (step 2) and the sabotaged car (step 4); the viewer whose wallet is already gone needs step 3 within minutes.

Gaps

- ⚠️ A3 Renton is February 2026: date in a Jeff note.
- ⚠️ A4 Lynnwood is December 2025: date in a Jeff note.
- ⚠️ A5 Vallejo is August 2025: date in a Jeff note. Timed on a Whisper transcript of the site video.
- ⚠️ A6 Portland is May 2024: date in a Jeff note.
- ⚠️ A7 no transcript: ABC4's captions were blocked three times. The TikTok's URL isn't published.
- ⚠️ A8 Auburn is September 2025: date in a Jeff note. Timed on a Whisper transcript of the site video.

- ⚠️ YouTube view counts and upload dates: not confirmed for any clip (bot wall); NBC Bay Area's San Jose upload showed ~23K in search.
- ⚠️ What our old "3 Costco SCAMS — EXPOSED LIVE!" (SKagNLR5x6M) covered is still unknown.

Open calls

- A3 and A4 LEGAL: the accused pleaded not guilty or are charged, not convicted; the copy says "police say" and the cuts skip the names. Approve.
- A5 LEGAL: the suspects are minors (unnamed, not shown). Approve.
- A7 THROTTLED: re-fetch ABC4's captions before the bible, or pull the TikTok by hand. A fresher option is the September 2026 Utah Costco case (gas door open, two men watching).
- A4 uses a second slice of the FOX 13 package (clip 2's source). If the room wants a different outlet, KCRA's "jewelry theft scams turn violent" (Sacramento) is the alternate once its captions come through.
- The demo (A8): book Jim Stickley for the Fri 11/20 taping?
- Costco on the record: ask for comment?
- Watch our old "3 Costco SCAMS" video before the bible, so no case repeats.
- The tap-to-pay donation standalone: when does it air?
- Sponsor spots for the break.